

JEONGMIN HA

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Citizenship: South Korea · U.S. Permanent Resident

EDUCATION

Ph.D. in Economics , Michigan State University	Aug 2021 – May 2027 (Expected)
M.A. in Economics , Michigan State University	2023
M.A. in Economics , Yonsei University, Republic of Korea	2021
B.A. in Economics & Applied Statistics , Yonsei University, Republic of Korea	2020

FIELDS OF INTEREST

Labor Economics, Public Economics, Economics of Education

JOB MARKET PAPER

The Racial Wage Gap and Task Segregation [\[Draft\]](#)

- *Abstract:* Despite substantial wage convergence between Black and White workers prior to 1980, the racial wage gap has since stagnated and even widened. This paper examines how much of this widening the occupational task structure accounts for, and whether it operates through shifts in task allocation between the two groups (task sorting) or through changes in the return to tasks (task prices). I find that racial disparities in task allocation have narrowed, reducing the gap. However, I find that this progress has been outpaced by a sharp rise in the Social task price. White men disproportionately benefited from the increased Social task price because Black men still remain underrepresented in Social-intensive occupations. To identify the specific Social tasks behind this price effect, I use machine learning to construct a data-driven task classification. I find that the widening gap is not driven by Coordination-Social tasks, such as management and scheduling, but by Analytical-Social tasks, such as analyzing and interpreting information for others. Together, these results suggest that racially neutral changes in task price are now the central mechanism widening the racial wage gap.

WORKING PAPERS

Pay Transparency and Gender Differences in Job Search (with Kexin Feng) [\[Draft\]](#)

- We examine how pay transparency affects wages and gender differences in labor-market outcomes. Using a difference-in-differences analysis of CPS data, we study whether Colorado's pay-transparency law narrows the gender wage gap, particularly among job changers.

Occupational Segregation by Race and Tipping Dynamics [\[Draft\]](#)

- *Abstract:* This paper examines whether Black-White and Hispanic-White occupational segregation exhibit “tipping” behavior—where White workers exit an occupation once they observe that the share of minority exceeds a “tipping point”. I find evidence of tipping dynamics only for Hispanics during the 1980-1990 period. These findings suggest that tipping is not a general feature of racial and ethnic occupational segregation.

PUBLICATIONS

- [1] "The Werther effect of celebrity suicides: Evidence from South Korea." with Hee-Seung Yang. *PLoS ONE* 16.4 (2021): e0249896. [\[Link\]](#)
- [2] "Do More Educated People Work for the Government?" with Elizabeth Kayoon Hur and Hee-Seung Yang. *Applied Economics Letters*, 30.2 (2023): 149-152. [\[Link\]](#)

WORKS IN PROGRESS

Safety Screening or Red Tape? Requiring In-Person Driver's License Renewal for Older Adults (with Elizabeth Kayoon Hur & Matthew Kaefer)

Trade Liberalization and Local Labor Market Adjustment: New Evidence from Korea (with Myungkyu Shim, Hee-Seung Yang & Seung Yong Yoo) [\[Draft\]](#)

PRESENTATIONS

2026	UM-UWO-MSU Labo(u)r Day Conference, Yonsei Emerging Researcher Forum, MSU Grand River Conference
2025	Southern Economic Association (SEA), MSU Empirical Micro Lunch Seminar, MSU Economics Grad Student Seminar
2024	Annual Meeting of the Southern Economic Association (SEA), 117th Annual Conference on Taxation (NTA), MSU Economics Grad Student Seminar, MSU Red Cedar Conference
2020	The Joint Economics Seminar of Four Leading Korean Universities, The Conference of Korean Labor and Income Panel Study at Korea Labor Institute

AWARDS / FELLOWSHIPS / SCHOLARSHIPS

Council of Graduate Students Conference Funding, MSU	2024
Summer Research Fellowship, MSU	2024
Council of Graduate Students Professional Development Funding, MSU	2024
Directed Research Fellowship, MSU	2023
Best Paper Prize, Graduate Student Research Paper Competition, Korea Labor Institute	2020
Integrated Undergraduate-Graduate Program Fellowship, Yonsei University	2020 – 2021
Inchoon Fellowship, Inchoon Scholarship Foundation	2014 – 2019
Guwon Fellowship, Guwon Scholarship Foundation	2018 – 2019
Semester Honors, Yonsei University	2016, 2018

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Michigan State University, Research Assistant for Prof. Antonio Galvao	2023
Yonsei University, Research Assistant for Prof. Hee-Seung Yang	2021

TEACHING EXPERIENCE

Instructor, Michigan State University	2025
<i>Survey of International Economics</i>	
Teaching Assistant, Michigan State University	2021 – 2026
<i>Public Revenues, Public Expenditures, Introduction to Macroeconomics, Intermediate Macro, Eval-</i>	

uating Evidence: Becoming a Smart Research Consumer, Senior Seminar for Economics Majors
Teaching Assistant / Tutor, Yonsei University 2018 – 2021
Current Issues in Development Economics (TA), Econometrics (Tutor)

SKILLS & ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- **Computer Skills:** Stata, Python, R, supervised/unsupervised ML
- **Languages:** Korean (native), English (fluent)

REFERENCES

Todd Elder

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